

Dance, baby dance

Dance Maker allows you to create original dance tracks through an intuitive interface. You can add music to any of your video clips using it. Creating songs is quite simple due to the drag and drop feature. The accompanying CD includes sound files, which can be imported while you are creating a song. This version carries support for DirectX plugins.

MAGIC Dance Maker



SPECIFICATIONS

Features: Real time mixer with a five-band equaliser; supports 16 tracks of audio, MIDI video or BMP data

verdict

B -

MAGIC Dance Maker

Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Small file size
- Low on extra audio effects
Price: Rs 850
Contact: Microsoft Computer Services
Phone: 022-8729525
Fax no: 8727446
E-mail: sales@mwcdrom.com
Web site: www.mwcdrom.com

Old and dependable

ZOC has several configurable options to suit your terminal emulation needs; from the plain Solaris telnet, to Linux with Midnight commander to BBSeS accessible from telnet. It's suitable for modem or shell account/BBSeS users and supports secure shell connections. ZOC supports almost all protocols used by earlier BBSeS even over telnet connections.

ZOC 4.02



SPECIFICATIONS

Features: You can define your own custom translations for a certain key phrase, which allows you to build any keystroke, or break/pause combo required in some UNIX terminals

verdict

B +

ZOC 4.02

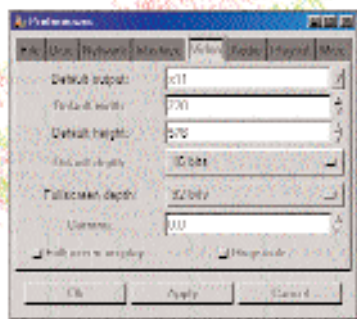
Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ REXX Scripting
- Needs extensive keyboard mapping for some terminal types
Price: \$69 (approximately Rs 3,312)
Web site: www.emtec.com

Musical notes

This software for playing MPEGs, MP2s and DVDs works on almost every operating system and has low system requirements. Although Videolan may not match up to a software such as PowerDVD, you really mustn't complain too much since it is free. Opt for Videolan if you don't mind the plain interface and are satisfied with the features it provides.

Videolan Client



SPECIFICATIONS

Features: You can stream files through the network; the preferences menu gives you a choice of interface, colour depth, gamma, and audio options; other options include slow motion, chapter, and language and subtitle selection

verdict

B

Videolan Client

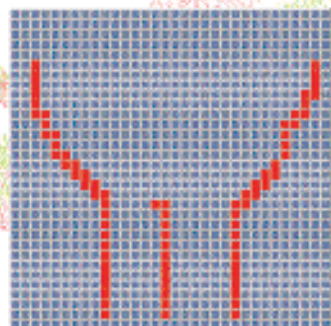
Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Good features
- Needs a better interface
Price: Freeware
Web site: www.videolan.org

Iconically speaking

Articons allows you to create or modify icons in colour depths of up to 16 million colours. While modifying images you can give them gradient or fill shadow or mirror effects. You can save your image as an image file or an icon. You can download the trial version of the software and use it for a period of 30 days.

Articons 3.01



SPECIFICATIONS

Features: You can edit .bmp or .jpg images up to a resolution of 127x127; easy drag-and-drop of icons between shells and libraries; can import a variety of image files for modification and export them to a format of your choice; during modification, you can zoom in or out, or add effects such as flip horizontally, roll left and others

verdict

B

Articons 3.01

Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Good features and tools
+ Easy-to-use
Price: Shareware
Web site: www.aha-soft.com